Code of Conduct and Business Ethics Policy

Document ID: EN-POL-03 **Department:** Legal and Compliance **Version:** 4.1 **Effective Date:** 1 January 2026

1. Purpose

This policy sets out the standards of ethical behaviour expected of all employees, directors, and contractors of Meridian Holdings Group in their dealings with colleagues, customers, suppliers, and the wider community.

2. Core Principles

2.1 Employees must act with honesty and integrity in all business dealings and must not engage in any conduct that could bring the Company into disrepute.

2.2 Conflicts of interest, whether actual or perceived, must be disclosed to the employee's line manager and recorded in the Conflicts of Interest Register maintained by the Compliance Department.

2.3 Employees must treat colleagues, customers, and business partners with respect and must not engage in discrimination, harassment, or bullying of any kind.

3. Gifts and Hospitality

3.1 Employees may accept gifts or hospitality of modest value (below £75) from business partners, provided this is declared to their line manager. Gifts exceeding this value must be declined or, where declining would cause offence, surrendered to the Company.

3.2 Cash or cash-equivalent gifts must never be accepted under any circumstances.

4. Confidential Information

4.1 Employees must protect confidential Company and customer information and must not disclose such information to unauthorised parties, whether during or after their employment.

5. Reporting Concerns

5.1 Employees who become aware of suspected breaches of this policy should report their concerns to their line manager, the Compliance Department, or through the confidential Whistleblowing Hotline detailed in Appendix A.

5.2 The Company prohibits retaliation against any employee who raises a concern in good faith under this policy.

6. Consequences of Breach

6.1 Breach of this policy may result in disciplinary action up to and including dismissal, and in serious cases may be reported to relevant regulatory or law enforcement authorities.

7. Related Documents

- Anti-Bribery and Corruption Policy (EN-POL-05)
- Whistleblowing Procedure (LEGAL-PROC-03)

8. Approval

Approved by the Board of Directors on 10 December 2025.